



OnePlus Nord

OnePlus is going to launch an affordable phone priced at around ₹22,000 called the OnePlus Nord. <https://digit.in/jul20-93>



New Acer products

Acer has announced new products across their gaming, creator, enterprise and business lineups. <https://digit.in/jul20-94>

Apple iPhone SE (2020)

Perfect blend of old and new

The original iPhone SE was released in 2016 and raked up a huge following for its compact form-factor and packing the newest SoC for the time. Four years later, fans of Apple's mobile devices have been again vying for a compact smartphone. Well, the iPhone SE 2020 is finally here, it's gone through our testing process and it has definitely left us impressed. The best way to sum up this new iPhone is that it's a very impressive mix of the iPhone 11 and the iPhone 8.

Build and design

For people who have small hands, the iPhone SE is an absolute boon. It's easy to use with a single hand. The return of the TouchID is great in the times of Coronavirus where a mask is nothing but a hindrance. It's just as fast and works well even with wet fingers. The volume buttons are on the left of the phone, within easy reach, as is the power button, on the right. The all-glass construction of the phone does make it a tad slippery and placing the phone on a slanted surface will make it slide off, especially if it starts to vibrate. After two years of thick iPhones, it's nice to finally have a compact model.

Performance

The iPhone SE 2020 is powered by the A13 Bionic, the same SoC found on the iPhone 11 series. Early benchmarks showed that the iPhone SE had lower benchmark scores in comparison to other A13 Bionic powered devices, sparking suggestions that Apple may have downclocked the chip in some ways. Turns out, the simple reason for this is the fact that the iPhone SE 2020 comes with 3GB of RAM while the 11 series sports 4GB of RAM.

Of the many things Apple has a track record for, it is consistently showing the irrelevance of benchmarks. When gaming on the iPhone SE, we

clocked 59 fps on both PUBG Mobile and Call of Duty Mobile while Asphalt 9 ran at a rock-solid 60fps. While Gamebench reported 93 percent frame stability for Call of Duty Mobile, both Asphalt 9 and PUBG Mobile ran with 99 percent frame rate stability. Good luck finding reasons to complain about this phone's performance.

As a daily driver, we switched from an iPhone 11 Pro over to the iPhone SE and there was practically no difference in the experience. Switching apps, going between photo editing in Adobe Lightroom Mobile and moving to CoD Mobile was fast, given that Apple has been using NVMe-based storage for some time now, apps load very quickly.

Display

One look at the iPhone SE 2020 and you will think you're looking at an iPhone 8. This means you get a 4.7-inch display with a thick top and bottom bezel. The 750 x 1334 resolution packed into a 4.7-inch panel gives the display a pixel density of 326 ppi, adequate for a very enjoyable viewing experience, and yes, it is an IPS LCD Panel.

Perhaps the most impressive thing about the iPhone SE's display is that it supports HDR content playback from Netflix and other sources. Apple's colour management takes care of the profile switching between DCI-P3 and sRGB, depending on the content on the display. Regardless of what you're watching on the display, whether a movie, a photo or even playing games, the visual acuity is very good thanks to accurate colour reproduction.



Price
₹42,500



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Camera

This is probably the one area where you're going to feel yourself wishing Apple had done more. The iPhone SE 2020 comes with a camera stack that's on-paper, identical to that of the iPhone 8. You have a 12-megapixel shooter on the back with an f/1.8 aperture and OIS. On the front, a 7-megapixel camera with an f/2.2 aperture. What you don't get is Night mode, a feature that continues to remain exclusive to the latest iPhones only. The Smart HDR algorithms work on the iPhone SE which is definitely a reason for the markedly improved dynamic range in the daytime photos shot from the iPhone SE. What stuck out as impressive was the level of detail retained in the photos. Taking photos is a snappy experience, with no shutter lag and very little time between shots.

Verdict

The iPhone SE 2020 gets a lot of things right. The performance is on the money and the form-factor is one that's been loved and lauded by many in the older iPhone era. It also brings all the right mix of features for the price point, such as an HDR display, IP67 rating and of course, that A13 Bionic SoC. The single camera may feel insufficient, as all other devices in the segment have at least two. If you have an old iPhone, upgrading to this one will be an improvement.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

OS: iOS 13 | CAPACITY: 64GB, 128GB, 256GB | DISPLAY: 4.7" Retina HD display | CHIP: A13 Bionic | WATER RESISTANCE: IP67 | PRIMARY CAMERA: 12MP wide | VIDEO: 4K at 24 fps, 30 fps or 60 fps | FRONT CAMERA: 7MP

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